

Brainstorm

For my photobooth website, I began by looking for inspiration. Although there are other online photobooth sites, I wanted to add my own twist to the concept. Since parts of the idea are new and creative, it's harder to make a direct comparison with existing options from the start. That's why I first started with doing research on real life photobooths, especially from Korea and Japan, where photobooths often produce more cute and playful photo strips, compared to other photobooths (so: part doing brainstorming, part doing competitive analysis).

These booths are known for their vibrant, pastel-colored designs that appeal to a wide audience, offering (once again) a more cute and playful aesthetic. I wanted to recreate this atmosphere with the colors and a simple, yet playful vibe, capturing that nostalgic and fun feeling.

LINE FRIENDS Photobooth:



Looking at this LINE FRIENDS PHOTOBOOTH, it has a vibrant and cute impression, with their fun mascottes representing their line and photobooth.

- 1. I felt like I also wanted to implement my own mascot in my future website, to make it more fun and memorable for users to go through my website.***

I also came across photobooths where users could take photos with their favorite K-pop idols, with multiple images of idols being placed over the user's own photo, creating a fun and personalized experience. This concept intrigued me, and as a huge anime fan, I realized I hadn't seen anything similar online or in real life that allowed users to take pictures with anime characters in this way.

- 2. Since I wanted to bring something new to the table, I decided to incorporate this idea into my photobooth website, allowing users to pose with their favorite anime characters and create unique, customized photo strips. This idea felt like the perfect way to connect my passion for anime with an engaging experience for users.***

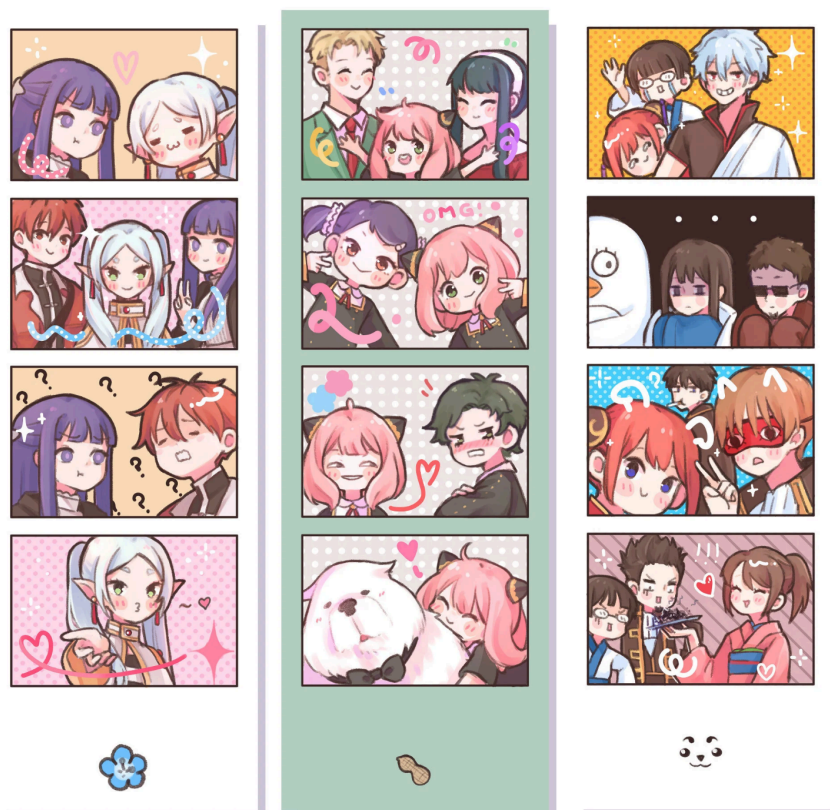
Plaza Singapura Photobooth:



Although I couldn't find many anime-specific photobooths, I did come across some ideas that closely aligned with my own vision. Many photobooths offered themed photo strips, where the design of the strip matched the theme of the booth. Some allowed users to include, like mentioned in the example above, a character or figure in the photo, adding a personalized touch to the experience.

This concept inspired me to create a photobooth where users could take themed photo strips with anime characters, blending the fun of personalized photobooths with the vibrant world of anime. I wanted to take this idea a step further by offering different anime themes and characters for users to choose from, allowing them to fully immerse themselves in a world of their favorite anime, while still implementing the cute and pastel colors of the Korean photobooths for the website itself.

Example:

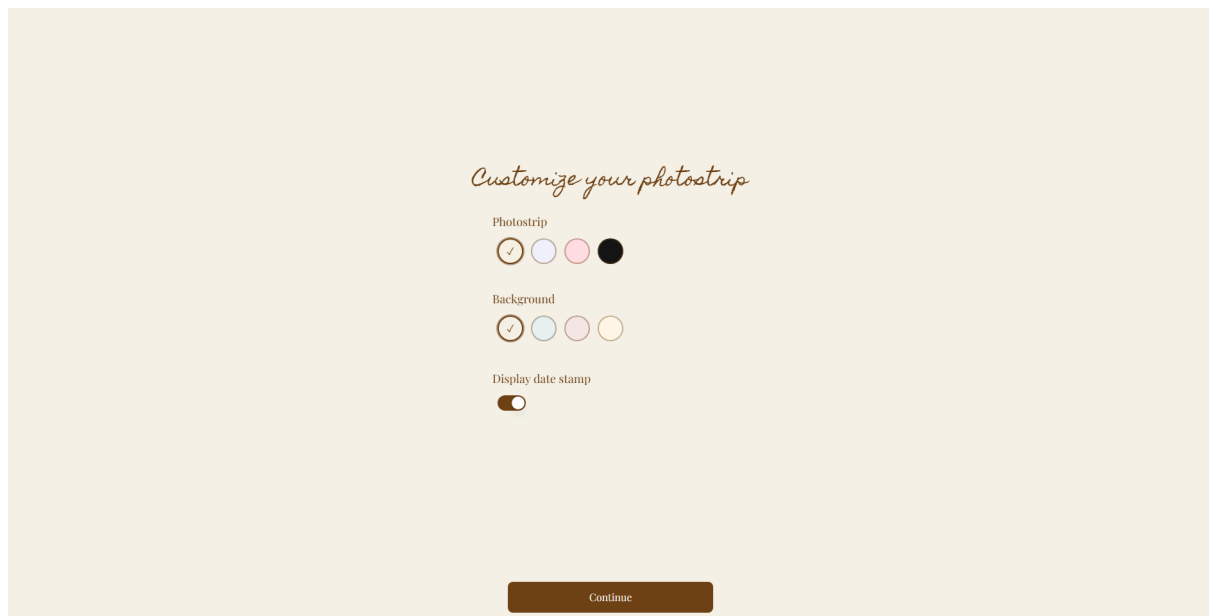


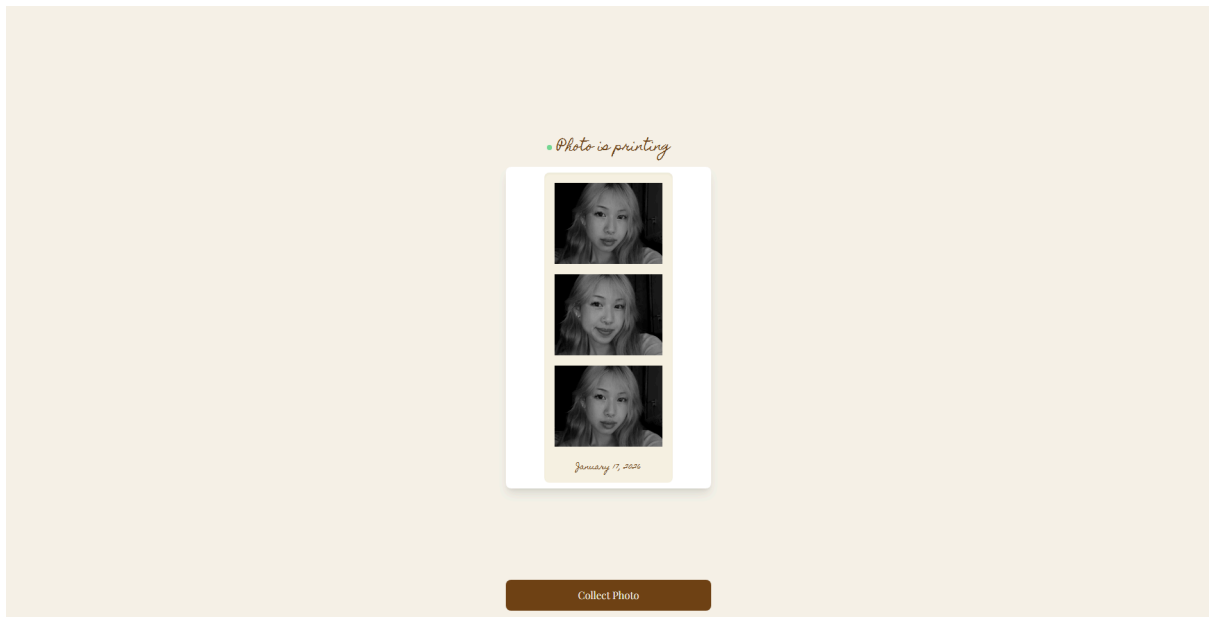
Competitive Analysis

So now I got the idea of my overall concept, I decided to do a competitive analysis and go through online photobooth websites made already, for the important functions for my own photobooth website. To make the comparison easier and more organized, I found three popular photobooth websites, each with its own distinct style. This allowed me to explore different elements and functionalities, helping me identify what works well and what could be incorporated into my own photobooth website. By comparing these websites, I could see which features were successful and which ones I could improve or adapt to fit my anime-inspired theme.

1. Little Vintage Photobooth:

- *Simplicity and clear process*: the website was very clear and easy to navigate, with minimal imagery. The user was guided step-by-step through the photobooth process on separate pages, avoiding overwhelming choices or clutter.
- *Limited design options*: you were given 3 photos to take. The design for the photostrip was also limited, which made the process simple and basic.



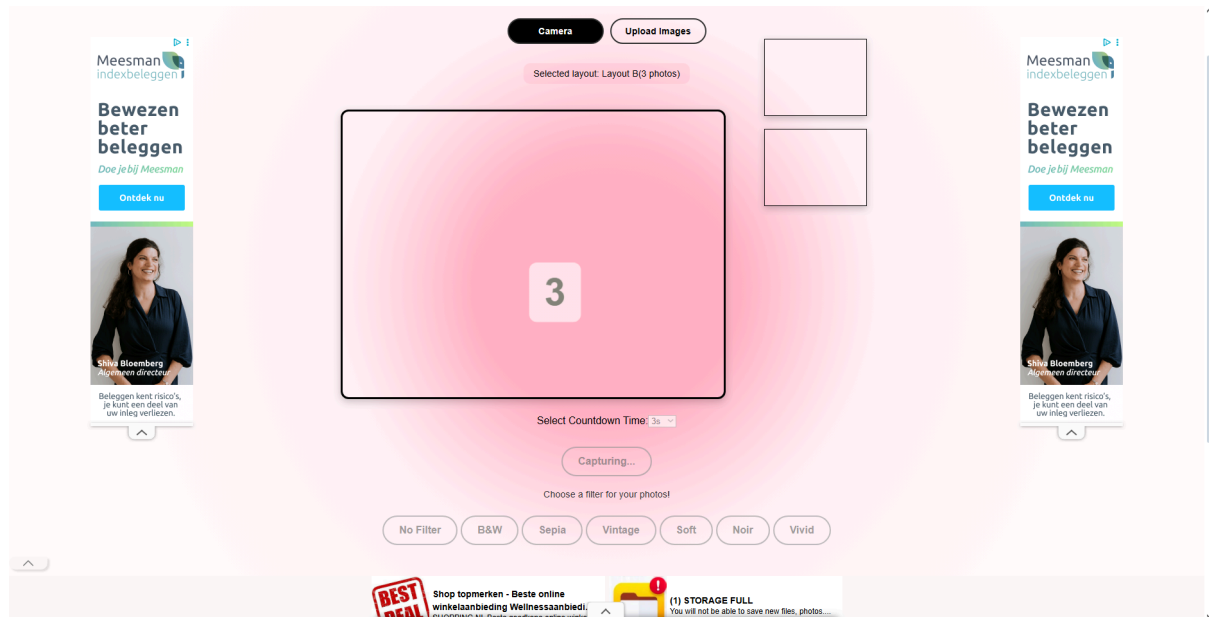


Potential downsides: the limited customization options, like no ability to change the color or add stickers, might be seen as a disadvantage by some users. It could be considered a restriction on creativity.

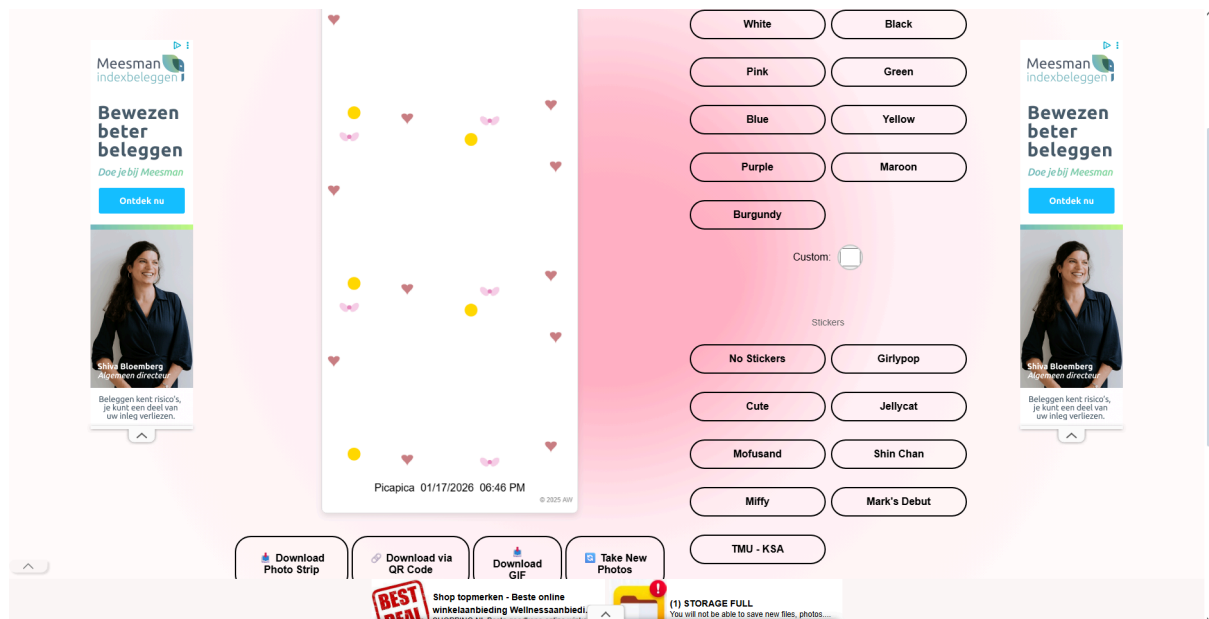
Why I chose similar features: I decided to keep the 3-photo limit and restrict the design options to make the experience more authentic, reflecting the real-world photobooth experience. I also prefer the simplicity and clarity of the process, which is why I'm applying this to my site (shortly said, I want to retain this authentic experience while the website itself has a more modern look, incorporating design elements inspired by Korean/Japanese photobooths).

2. Picapica Photobooth:

- *More options and features:* this website offered a wider range of options, including the ability to change the number of photos, apply filters and adjust the timer for taking pictures.
- *Photo preview:* users could see a preview of how the photo looked that was taken, besides the webcam. This could help ensure the shot looks good before printing.



- *Customization:* after the photos were printed, users could choose from various colors and stickers to decorate their photo strip.

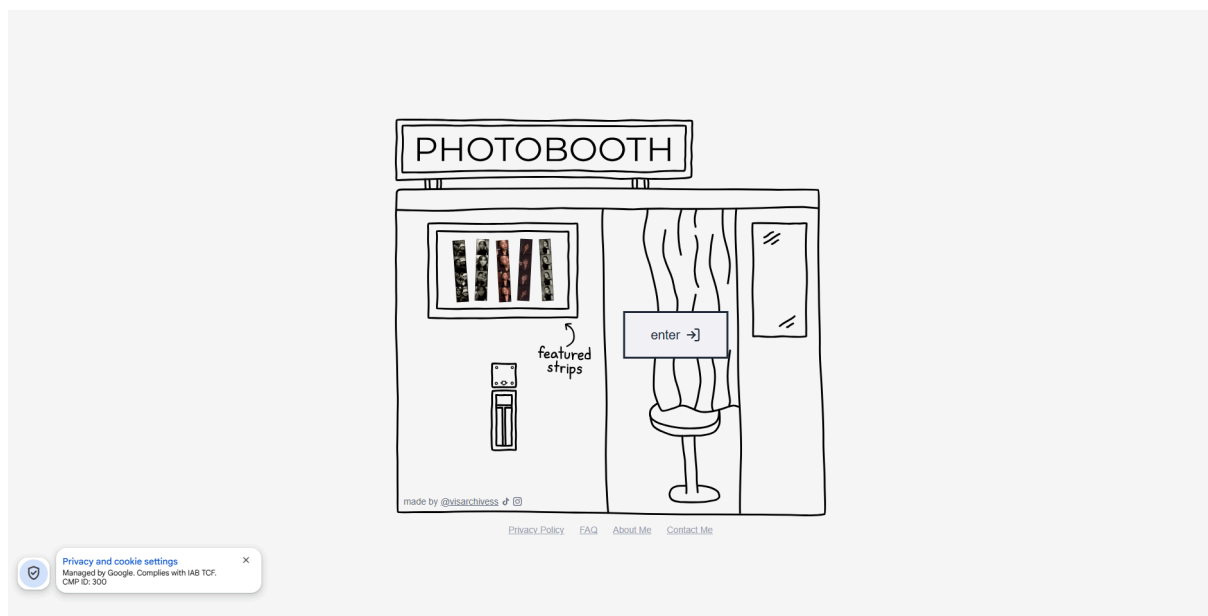


Potential downsides: the site had many ads, making it feel visually cluttered and distracting. While there were many customization options, the design choices (like colors and stickers) were presented in text form, with no preview. This made it harder for users to imagine what their final strip would look like without pressing each option.

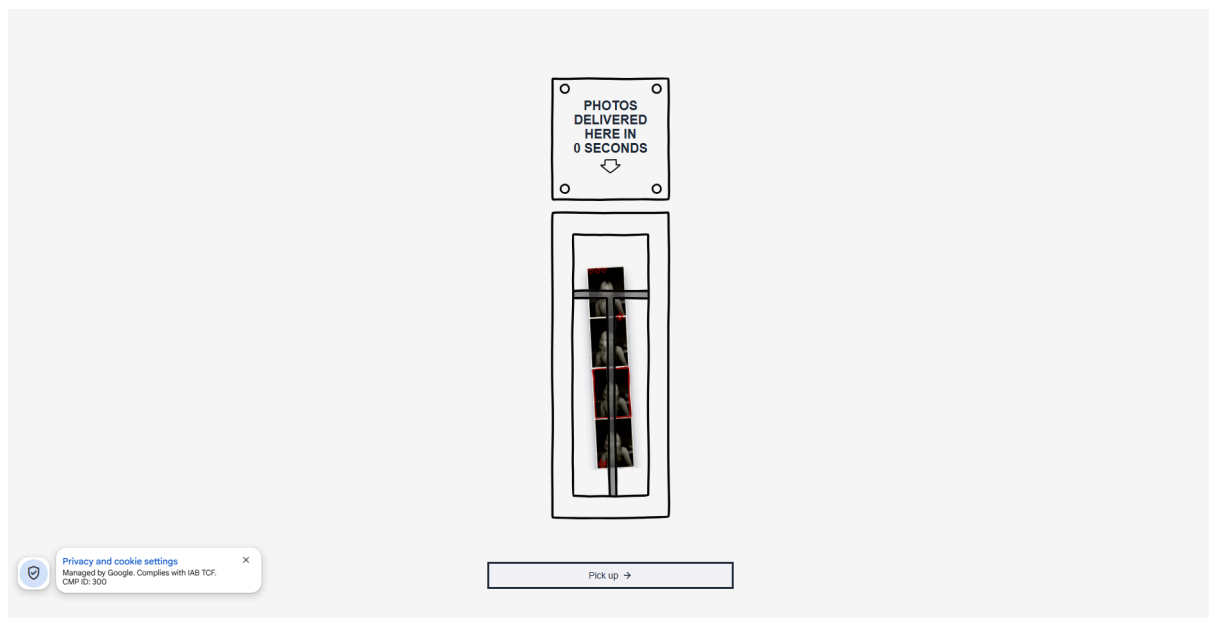
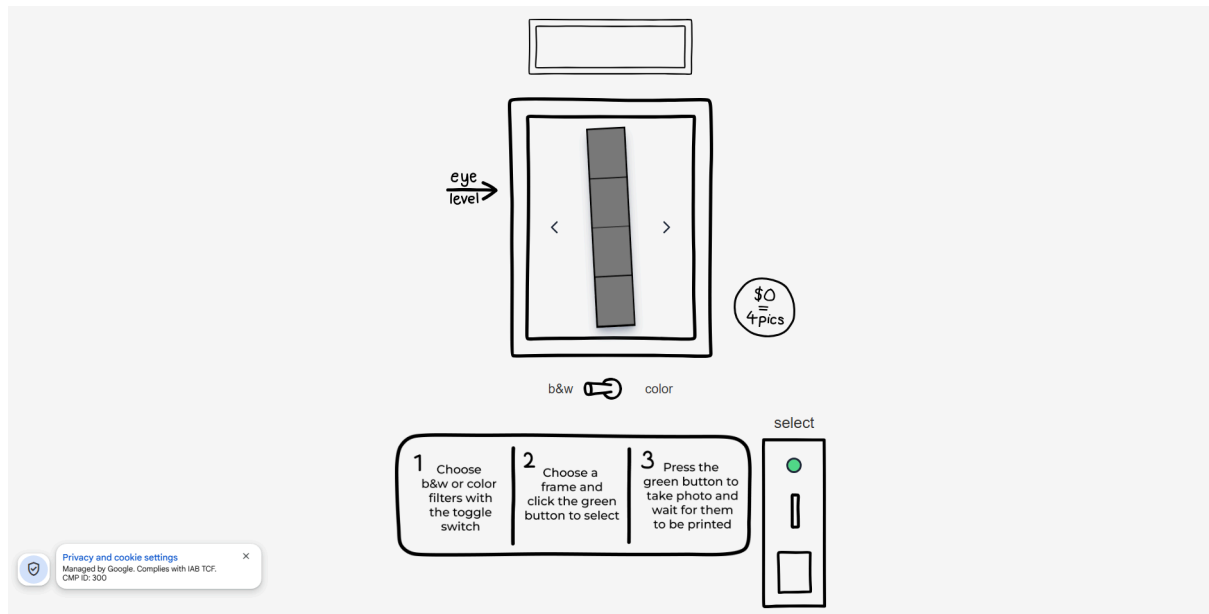
Why I chose similar features: while PicaPica offered more options, I prefer a more authentic photobooth experience with limited customization, which is closer to the real-world experience. I will keep the design options from the first site: fewer options, but with clear previews, so users know exactly what they are choosing before finalizing. That's also why I won't include a timer or photo count option, to maintain the authenticity of the experience. I will borrow the Y2K aesthetic colors from PicaPica, as the vibrant, pastel and playful look aligns with the colorful Korean/Japanese photobooth style, which I want to recreate in my own design.

3. MySketchBooth:

- *Authentic and interactive experience:* this site provided the most authentic and interactive experience. It had a fun sketch design of every photobooth element and made the user feel like they were actually inside a photobooth.



- *Limited options:* like the first site, it offered limited choices, which made the process straightforward and user-friendly.
- *Visual interaction:* the actions you performed were visually represented, enhancing the experience by making it feel like a real photobooth.



Potential downsides: the sketches in the design kept moving, which could make it feel slightly “annoying”, though this effect was minimal and not overwhelming.

Why I chose similar features: this site inspired me in terms of interactivity and the unique sketch design, which I found memorable and playful. I love the step-by-step page flow, which mirrors the experience of a physical booth. I want to implement this type of interactive, visual guidance on my own website to make it feel as authentic and fun as possible. I do want to take inspiration from the visually engaging design and make the whole process feel more like a real booth experience.

Conclusion:

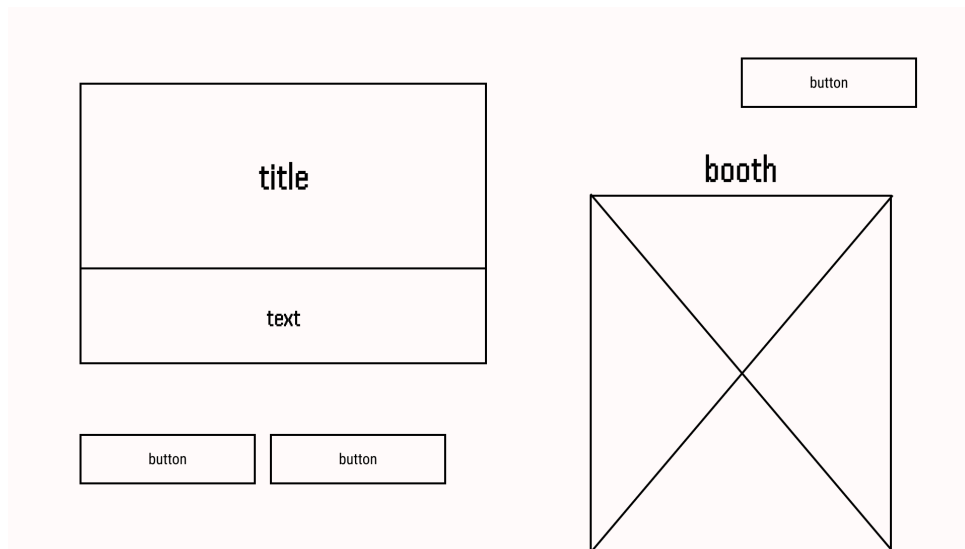
- *Authentic experience*: focus on a simple, step-by-step process with limited customization (3 photos, no timer, etc.) to maintain the real-world photobooth feel.
- *Anime theme*: offer a unique twist by allowing users to pose with their favorite anime characters, adding a fun and personalized touch to the photo strips.
- *Vibrant, pastel design*: incorporate Y2K-inspired colors and playful elements from Korean/Japanese photobooths to create an engaging and visually appealing atmosphere.
- *Clear previews (design)*: provide clear previews of design options to help users visualize the final product before printing.
- *Interactive design*: use interactive, step-by-step navigation to mimic the booth experience, making it more engaging and fun for users.

This combines authenticity, creativity and a playful anime twist to offer a unique photobooth experience.

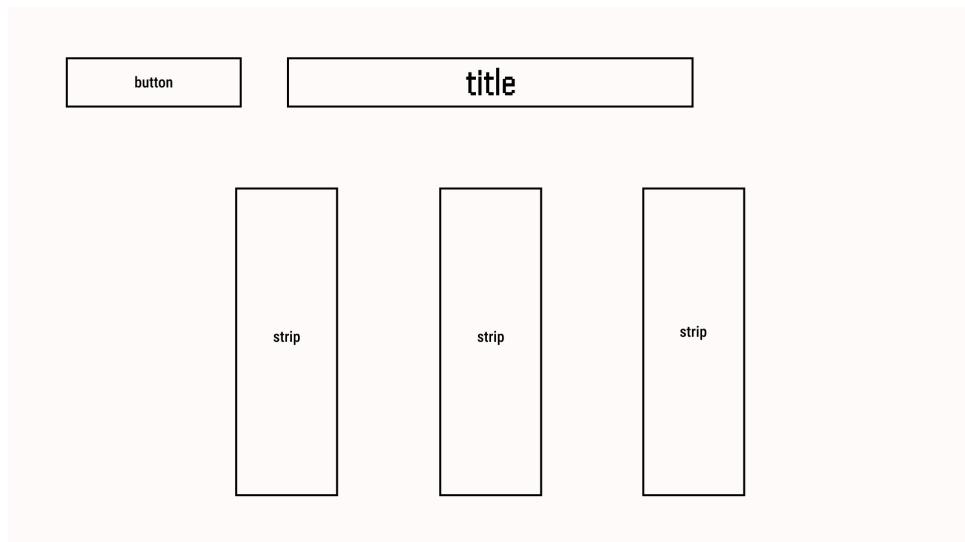
Wireframes

For my wireframes, I chose to design my photobooth website as a simple, intuitive and interactive experience, with a focus on clear navigation through different stages. The main pages are as follows:

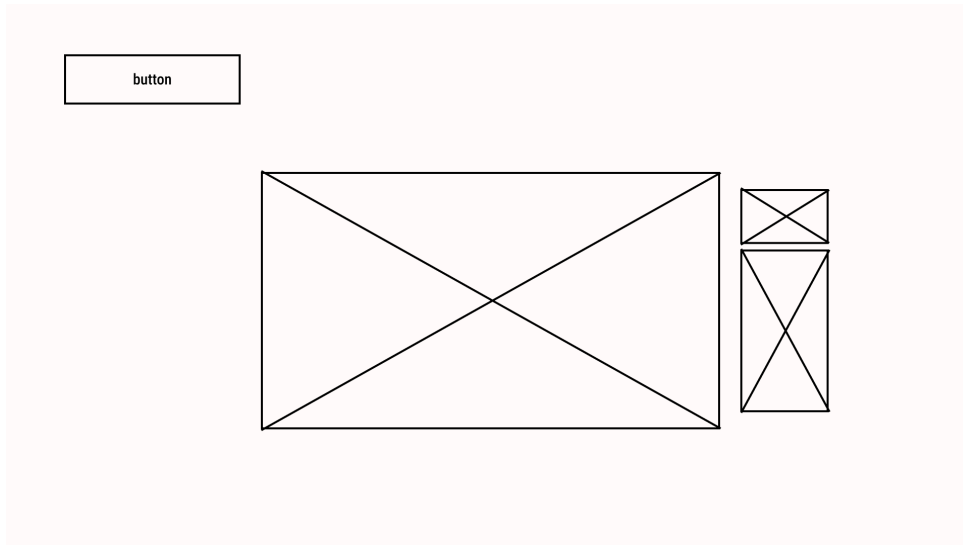
1. Homepage (outside photobooth): the landing page introduces the photobooth experience, where users can start their journey.



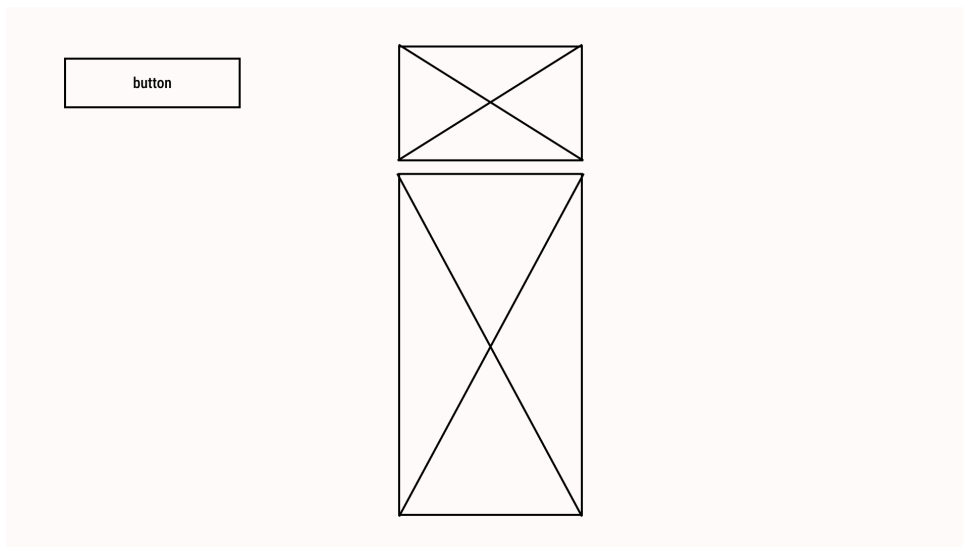
2. Photostrip page (choosing design): this page allows users to choose from different anime-themed designs. Here, they can also preview their chosen design before moving forward.



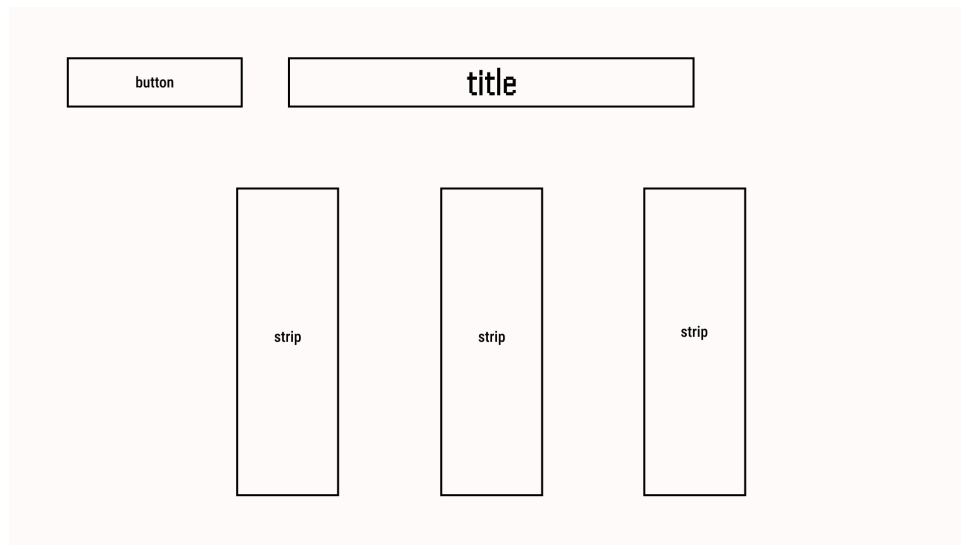
3. Booth page (in the booth): on this page, users enter the virtual booth and can take their photos. It will simulate the experience of being in a photobooth, with interactive elements guiding them through the process.



4. Printer page (printing photos on the photostrip): once users are happy with their photos, this page allows them to view their photostrip and save.



5. Gallery page (view saved photos like a diary): after printing, users can browse and view their saved photos from previous sessions in the gallery.



View the wireframes? Click [here](#).

Prototype

For my photobooth I did **brainstorming/competitive analysis** and **wireframes**, and created a design based on these products. I made sure to:

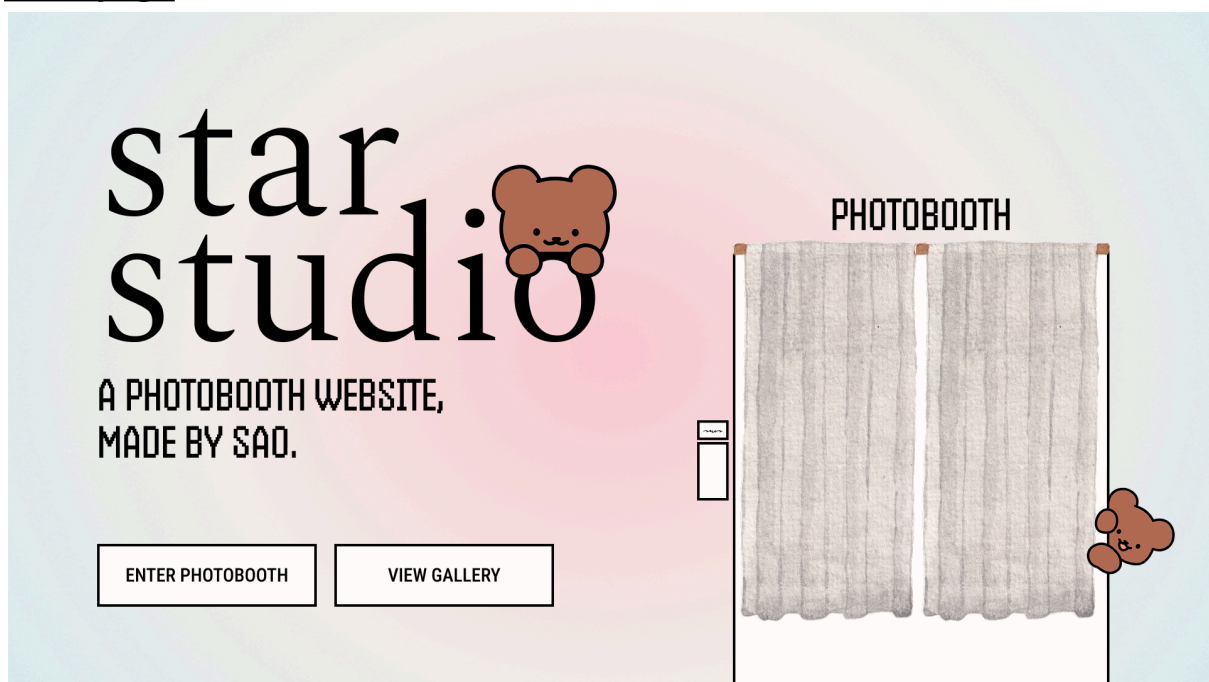
- Make a playful and vibrant design: inspired by the Korean/Japanese photobooth style, using pastel colors and a Y2K aesthetic to create a fun and cute vibe (as well as a little mascot).
- Personalization: incorporating anime characters into the photostrip, allowing users to pose with their favorite anime figures for a unique and personalized experience.
- Limited options for authentic experience: following the inspiration from Little Vintage Photobooth and MySketchBooth, offering a simple and authentic experience with step-by-step guidance and a 3-photo limit.
- Interactivity: inspired by MySketchBooth's visual interaction, users will see a preview of their photostrip.

The website will be divided into distinct stages: homepage (starting point), photostrip page (design selection), booth page (taking photos), printer page (final preview and print) and gallery page (view saved photos).

Fonts

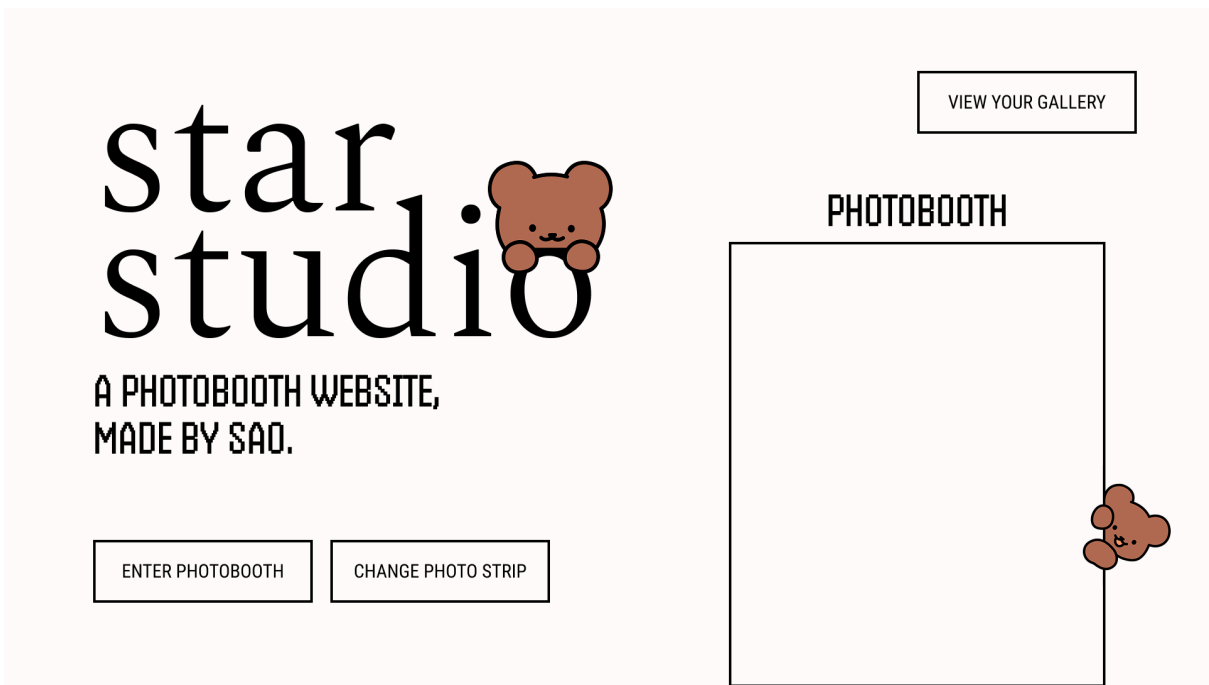
- **Logo:** Spectral. Simple but pretty, with gentle curves. Easy to read and evident.
- **Important titles:** Handjet. Pixelated, which fits the Korean/Japanese photobooth style and Y2K aesthetic.
- **Other text:** Roboto Condensed. Simple and neat. Easy to read and evident.

Homepage:



For all pages, homepage included, I made the photobooth elements on Figma with simple figures, while using Canva elements for the mascot (and in this case with the homepage, the curtains).

Homepage before Canva:



Photostrip page:



CHANGE PHOTO STRIP

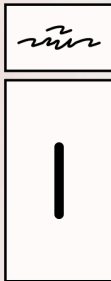
[PATTERNED: JUJUTSU KAISEN INSPIRED]



Booth page:

GO BACK

LOOK HERE!



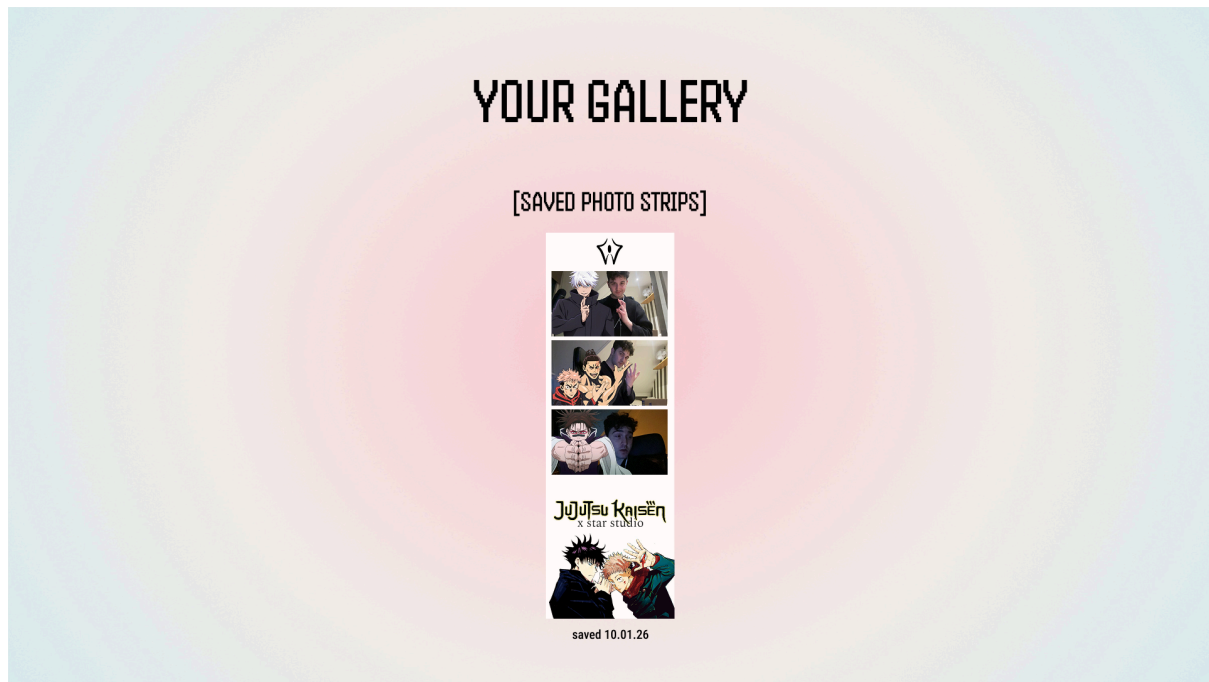
Printer page:



Feedback:



Gallery page:



View the prototype? Click [here](#).

Feedback !: I started **user-testing** anime fans, which you can read more about in my separate user-testing documentation for more information and details, but the most important points were that:

- Many users especially liked the concept of the photostrips featuring anime characters, as it felt fun and unique. They also enjoyed how the strips were decorated with cool images and elements that matched the theme of the anime. However, a few users mentioned that it would be even better if each "special anime strip" had its own color, to make the strip feel even more personalized and tied to the specific anime theme. They thought this would enhance the overall experience, making the strips feel even more unique and customized.
- One user mentioned that they really liked how the photobooth elements reappeared on the printer page, as it helped maintain the photobooth experience. However, they also suggested that I could enhance the interactivity by making these elements more prominent and clearer, so the immersive feeling would be even stronger.

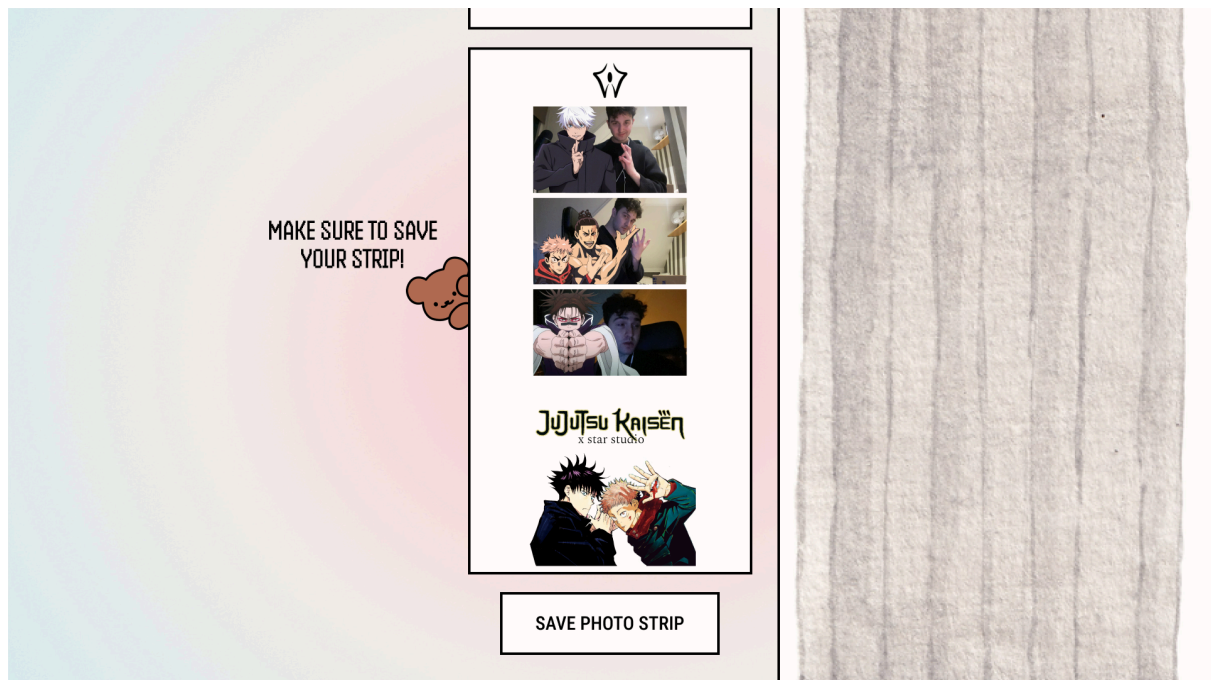
Taking this feedback into account, I decided to add a gradient background to each photostrip, using color palettes that match the theme of the anime characters. This way, the strips would not only feel more special but also visually aligned with the anime itself. I also decided to make the photobooth elements larger and more noticeable.

I added the curtains from the outside of the photobooth to give the impression that users are still standing outside the booth, waiting for their photos to print. This way, the interactivity and immersive experience would feel more complete and engaging. I also added my mascot and an extra save button for the strip.

Photostrip page (changed):



Printer page (changed):



Feedback II: I asked a teacher for feedback, and he mentioned that overall, he really liked the concept. Besides the special anime strips, he also really enjoyed the strips with patterns from Jujutsu Kaisen. He suggested that it would be even better if I could offer this for other anime series as well, so users could have more variety and choose from different, unique strips. Since my design options are already limited because of my intentional choice of keeping it like that, this would provide more choices for the users while still keeping the overall experience focused and consistent.

Taking this feedback into account, I expanded the range of anime-themed strips (most patterns were saved from [pinterest.com](https://www.pinterest.com)) available to users, while still maintaining the limited design options to keep the experience authentic and simple. In doing so, I made sure to be mindful of copyright concerns. However, since this project is not intended for commercial use, I didn't anticipate it being a significant issue *if* I happened to misjudge any copyright aspects in the first place.

Other strips:



CHANGE PHOTO STRIP

[PATTERNED: FRIEREN INSPIRED]



CHANGE PHOTO STRIP

[PATTERNED: NANA INSPIRED]



Feedback III: I presented my idea again to the same people I used for user-testing, and they all thought the photobooth website was great now. One person mentioned that, even though they did like the idea of a gallery page, they wouldn't know if lots of people would really use it, since you can already save the photo on your own desktop.

That's why I decided to change the gallery page into a community page while coding later on, where users can choose to share their strips, allowing others to view them if they'd like their strip to be featured on the site.

Heuristic Design Principles

- *Simplicity*: keep the design clean and uncluttered to make navigation intuitive. Avoid overwhelming the user with too many options or visuals.
- *Consistency*: maintain a consistent design style throughout the website, especially with colors, fonts, and imagery. This ensures users know what to expect from each page.
- *Feedback*: provide users with clear feedback, such as showing a preview of the photo strip, confirming actions like saving or printing, and ensuring the photobooth elements remain visible throughout the process.
- *Accessibility*: ensure that text is legible for all users. Make sure that images and buttons are clear and clickable.
- *Aesthetic and minimalist design*: incorporate a playful yet simple aesthetic (such as pastel colors, a fun mascot and clean layouts), maintaining a balance between being visually engaging without cluttering the interface.
- *Personalization*: allow users to customize their photostrip experience by offering themed anime strips and patterned strips, adding a personal touch without complicating the design-part.

These principles focus on user experience, simplicity and providing an engaging atmosphere without overwhelming users with choices.

User-testing

I decided to go online and ask a server (mostly people in the Netherlands who like to game with each other) who were anime fans and who would not mind to user-test my prototype and site. In total, there were five people (who said “yes” to being an anime fan) who wanted to take the time to go through my Figma prototype of my photobooth. I felt that they could give me useful feedback on whether:

- The anime-themed photo strips are engaging and fun for the target audience.
- The process of selecting and customizing strips feels intuitive and user-friendly.
- The overall design captures the playful, anime-inspired aesthetic in a way that resonates with the anime community.
- There are enough customization options without overwhelming the user or losing the “authentic photobooth experience”.
- The interactive features (like the “booth” feel and character integration) enhance the overall experience and make it memorable.

Before asking the set of questions mentioned above (the interview), I first let them navigate freely and observed their behavior. Afterwards, I noted down the most important points and answers to complete my user test.

Interview:

- What stands out to you first when you open my website?
- How does the impression feel?
- Is there anything you feel is missing?
- Could you easily find what you were looking for?
- If you could change anything about the navigation or structure, what would it be?
- Is the text easy to read?
- Do I maintain a consistent visual style throughout the site?

Key findings:

- In general, all users mentioned that the website layout is very clear and easy to navigate. The functions are intuitive, and the simple yet colorful design, along with the mascot, adds a fun touch. Because I decided for minimal options with not too much information, users didn't feel overwhelmed or confused in any way.
- Many users especially liked the concept of the photostrips featuring anime characters, as it felt fun and unique. They also enjoyed how the strips were decorated with cool images and elements that matched the theme of the anime. However, one user mentioned that it would be even better if each "special anime strip" had its own color, to make the strip feel even more personalized and tied to the specific anime theme. They thought this would enhance the overall experience, making the strips feel even more unique and customized.
- Another user mentioned that they really liked how the photobooth elements reappeared on the printer page, as it helped maintain the photobooth experience. However, they also suggested that I could enhance the interactivity by making these elements more prominent and clearer, so the immersive feeling would be even stronger.

Taking this feedback into account, I decided to add a gradient background to each photostrip, using color palettes that match the theme of the anime characters. This way, the strips would not only feel more special but also visually aligned with the anime itself. I also decided to make the photobooth elements larger and more noticeable.

I added the curtains from the outside of the photobooth to give the impression that users are still standing outside the booth, waiting for their photos to print. This way, the interactivity and immersive experience would feel more complete and engaging. I also added my mascot and an extra save button for the strip.

Feedback I: I asked a teacher for feedback, and he mentioned that overall, he really liked the concept. Besides the special anime strips, he also really enjoyed the strips with patterns from Jujutsu Kaisen. He suggested that it would be even better if I could offer this for other anime series as well, so users could have more variety and choose from different, unique strips. Since my design options are already limited because of my intentional choice of keeping it like that, this would provide more choices for the users while still keeping the overall experience focused and consistent.

Taking this feedback into account, I expanded the range of anime-themed strips (most patterns were saved from [pinterest.com](https://www.pinterest.com)) available to users, while still maintaining the limited design options to keep the experience authentic and simple. In doing so, I made sure to be mindful of copyright concerns. However, since this project is not intended for commercial use, I didn't anticipate it being a significant issue **if** I happened to misjudge any copyright aspects in the first place.

Feedback II: I presented my idea again to the same people I used for user-testing, and they all thought the photobooth website was great now. One person mentioned that, even though they did like the idea of a gallery page, they wouldn't know if lots of people would really use it, since you can already save the photo on your own desktop.

That's why I decided to change the gallery page into a community page while coding later on, where users can choose to share their strips, allowing others to view them if they'd like their strip to be featured on the site.

[Coding]

View my repository for this project? Click [here](#).

To code my photobooth website, I followed a similar setup process to what I did for my portfolio project. First, I installed the necessary libraries and frameworks, including Next.js, React and Tailwind, to ensure my project had a solid foundation. Afterward, I searched for tutorials that would help me understand the key functionalities I needed for my site, particularly how to set up a webcam feature (since this is the core functionality of my site).

I found a tutorial that specifically covered the basics of integrating a webcam into a website, which was a critical step for my project. Through this tutorial, I learned how to:

- Set up the webcam: I figured out how to access the webcam using ``navigator.mediaDevices.getUserMedia()`` and display it on the page with a coded canvas.
- Implement a countdown timer: I learned how to create a 7-second countdown for each photo-taking session.
- Take and save photos: I figured out how to capture the video frame, convert it into a photo and save the image for later use (to print on a photostrip).

By practicing this setup, I was able to integrate the webcam functionality seamlessly into my site.

View the tutorial I watched for this? Click [here](#).

After that, I needed to ensure I could store the captured photos and place them onto a designed photostrip with the overlays. There were limited tutorials that showed how to implement this feature, so I turned to ChatGPT to clarify some doubts:

- How do I store the pictures so they can later be printed on a photostrip with a design I've already created? Additionally, with the special strips, how can I ensure the anime figures are printed on the pictures as well, considering that the figures are not captured in the booth? They are only displayed as a "preview" to help users pose for the photo with the anime figure.

This was a very important question, because I wasn't sure if I could directly layer my photos on top of an SVG/PNG design, as I wanted to use specific images I'd sourced from [pinterest.com](#). I quickly learned that I could create a blank photostrip in code and apply overlays on top of it. I decided to use a "blank" photostrip and apply my design as an overlay. This allows me to incorporate the beautiful patterns, while maintaining control over how each photo is placed.

In the code, this is implemented as follows:

1. The base photostrip: each photo is placed on a strip with a defined width and height. The strip background (which is a SVG/PNG) is selected based on the user's choice (example: ``/jjk_special.png`` for Jujutsu Kaisen Special).
2. The overlays: overlays specific to each selected strip (like ``jjk_overlay1.svg``) are placed on top of each photo. The position of these photos and overlays is precisely mapped using coordinates (``photoPositions``).
3. The final photo strip: when the user clicks the "Save Photo Strip" button, I use the ``html2canvas`` library to capture the whole layout, including the photos, background, and overlays, and convert it into a downloadable PNG file.

I still realized I struggled a lot with `html2canvas`, because even though I got to implement their functions and it started to work, when saving a photo, it would still be very blurry all the time. I fixed this by:

- Adjusting the `html2canvas` settings: I increased the scale factor to improve the resolution of the saved image. Specifically, I set the scale option to 4, which made the canvas rendering more detailed and less pixelated when saving the image.
- Increasing the size of my PNG/SVG elements: since my design used overlays and photostrip backgrounds as PNG/SVG files, I made sure that the dimensions of these elements were scaled up. This ensured that when they were rendered in the final image (which would be scaled down to the smaller photostrip size), they would maintain their sharpness.
- Adjusting the pixel density: I also worked on ensuring that the images and elements, especially the overlays, were rendered at a higher pixel density. By doing so, I was able to improve pixelation and blurry images when the photostrip was saved at a smaller resolution.

Those were the most important functions of my website. Once I was able to fix these issues, learn from the process and add comments to my code to help me remember certain functions, I had already tackled the most challenging parts. From there, I moved on to coding the other pages, designing them and adding final touches like fun, copyright-free sounds to enhance interactivity. For example, I included a "coin sound" when users start taking pictures in the booth, and general "button sounds" to make the experience more engaging. To make my "special strips" even more unique, I incorporated voice lines from the anime itself, adding an extra layer of immersion for anime fans.

As with other projects, I made sure to consistently work in branches to keep practicing my version control skills. I also created a README where I incorporated feedback from previous projects to structure it properly.

View my hosted photobooth website? Click [here](#).